

# Chicago Tribune



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## Iran, US putting more focus on strait

Both issue warnings; Israel inspects nuclear research site

By Alon Bernstein, Sam Metz and Samy Magdy  
ASSOCIATED PRESS

ARAD, Israel — The United States and Iran threatened to target critical infrastructure Sunday as the war in the Middle East enters its fourth week.

Iran said the Strait of Hormuz, crucial to oil and other exports, would be “completely

closed” immediately if the U.S. follows up on President Donald Trump’s threat to attack its power plants. Trump late Saturday set a 48-hour deadline to open the strait.

Israeli leaders visited one of two southern communities near a secretive nuclear research site struck by Iranian missiles late Saturday, with scores of people wounded. Prime Minister Benjamin Netanyahu said it was a “miracle” no one was killed. Israel detected more Iranian missiles fired toward the area Sunday evening.

Netanyahu also claimed Israel and the U.S. were well on their way to achieving their war

goals. The aims have ranged from weakening Iran’s nuclear program, missile program and support for armed proxies to enabling the Iranian people to overthrow the theocracy.

The developments signaled the war, which the U.S. and Israel launched Feb. 28, was moving in a dangerous new direction, despite Trump’s comment last week he was considering “winding down” operations. It has killed over 2,000 people, rattled the global economy and sent oil prices surging.

The Iranian-backed Hezbollah in Lebanon claimed responsibility for an airstrike that killed a man in northern Israel, while Leba-

nese President Joseph Aoun called Israel’s targeting of bridges in the south “a prelude to a ground invasion.”

Iran has practically closed the Strait of Hormuz that connects the Persian Gulf to the rest of the world. Roughly one-fifth of global oil supply passes through it, but attacks on ships and threats of further strikes have stopped nearly all tanker traffic. Some of the largest oil producers have made cuts because their crude has nowhere to go.

The U.S. and its allies in Europe and Asia

See **IRAN** on Page A4

## Texts reveal split over school tax credit plan

In message to comptroller, Pritzker raises red flags over Trump-backed program

By Jeremy Gorner  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

SPRINGFIELD — A text from Gov. JB Pritzker to Comptroller Susana Mendoza is exposing a split between the two Illinois Democrats over whether the state should participate in a federal tax incentive program championed by Republicans and signed into law by President Donald Trump.

Pritzker, who has not yet decided whether Illinois will opt into the program, was raising red flags about how the policy could be used — particularly whether it might steer taxpayer-backed benefits to private schools that promote discriminatory views.

Pritzker sent the lengthy message to Mendoza last month after she wrote an opinion piece in the Chicago Tribune urging Illinois to join the federal program. In the text, the governor warned Mendoza that the incentives could support schools that “teach values that are racist or antisemitic or Anti-American.”

“State/federal tax credit dollars would go to support schools that teach children that gay people are evil, that ‘the KKK was fighting against the decline of morality,’ that white supremacy is God’s will — and other crazy notions,” Pritzker texted Mendoza.

The message, obtained by the Tribune through an open-records request, shows a governor taking a cautious, wait-and-see approach to a Trump-backed policy —

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BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE PHOTOS



## Shufflin’ on

**Top:** Participants run down State Street through Chicago’s Loop during the 45th running of the Shamrock Shuffle 8K on Sunday. Thousands of runners and walkers participated in the event, which takes place in Grant Park and the downtown area and kicks off Chicago’s spring running season.

**Left:** Diego Padilla, 7, offers high-fives to runners while waiting for his mom to pass along Wacker Drive through Chicago’s Loop.



Angel Garcia Sr. and his wife, Jillian Bernas Garcia, walk with their three children, Angel Garcia Jr., 4, Rose Garcia, 1, and Patricia Garcia, 5, after picking up Patricia from St. Hubert Catholic School in Hoffman Estates on Feb. 18. The Garcias are actively trying to prevent the school from being closed. **STACEY WESCOTT/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

## St. Hubert parents appeal to Vatican

Supporters push to keep Catholic school’s doors open

By Hope Moses  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

St. Hubert Catholic School in Hoffman Estates is set to close at the end of the academic year. But parents and supporters have taken their case more than 4,000 miles away to the Vatican — a Hail Mary attempt to save their school from closure.

When the Archdiocese of Chicago made it clear last month that its decision to shutter six financially strapped and underenrolled Chicago-area schools was final, a coalition of St. Hubert’s parents and supporters said they aren’t giving up.

Searching for options to save the school, St. Hubert parents Jillian Bernas Garcia and her husband, Angel, discovered a lesser-known reconsideration process within canon law

See **SCHOOL** on Page A5

## Judge backs work permit for officer arrested by ICE

Government temporarily barred from revoking employment authorization

By Tess Kenny  
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Amid the Trump administration’s 64-day local mass deportation campaign in October, U.S. Customs and Immigration Enforcement officers arrested then-Hanover Park police Officer Radule Bojovic for allegedly overstaying a tourist visa. His department, in turn, placed the Montenegro native on administrative leave.

Now, a federal judge has ruled that at least for the time being, the government cannot deny Bojovic his ability to work — after he was ultimately left jobless amid the government’s efforts to do just that.

U.S. District Judge Jorge Alonso last

week ruled the government is temporarily barred from revoking Bojovic’s employment authorization, effective for 14 days.

The Wednesday order comes after the government revoked Bojovic’s work permit in January, and after he was subsequently let go from the Hanover Park Police Department, village officials confirmed to the Tribune.

Bojovic “is a public servant who has not been shown to present any threat to the community (quite the opposite, if anything), and the Court fails to see what the government gains by suspending his employment without pay based on what appears likely to be, so far as the parties have shown as this early stage, a legal and/or factual error,” Alonso wrote in his Tuesday order.

Bojovic’s arrest was widely publi-

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### ICE issues detainer in shooting of student

Agency asks Illinois officials not to release a suspect, a Venezuelan migrant, according to the agency, who was arrested in connection with the death of a Loyola student. **Chicagoland, Page A3**

### Illini bring back the nasty in Sweet 16 bid

With two blowout wins over Penn and VCU in the NCAA Tournament, Illinois showed that the toughness that was in doubt after their Big Ten Tournament loss to Wisconsin is still there. **Sports**

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